



Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Interview Prep Pack

Thank you for taking the time to interview with us.

Here are some resources to help you prepare, as well as some final tips.

[Behavioral Question Prep](#)

[Technical Interview Prep](#)

[Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Core Values](#)

What you can expect from us

We customize each interview loop in advance. Each interviewer is thoughtfully assigned a focus area to assess, keeping the skills needed for the role in mind.

An interview is a conversation. Your interview is an interactive conversation where you are encouraged to ask us questions. We are excited to learn about your skills and interests but want to ensure we give you an opportunity to learn about us too!

We evaluate for technical skill and team fit. Our interviews are rooted in behavioral-based questions which draw upon your previous experience and expertise. We want to hear about past situations or challenges you have faced and how you handled them. When you are interviewing for a technical role, you may be asked technical questions designed to assess your ability to solve problems efficiently and effectively.

Interview debrief. After your interview, the interviewers will meet to discuss the results of your interviews. All feedback is independently collected and then assessed against the criteria of the position.

We will get back to you quickly. Our goal is to provide you with a decision within a week of the interview. If you have pending offers or your situation requires a quick decision, let your Talent Advisor know and we will make every effort to accommodate your timing.

Interview feedback. While we value and appreciate the importance of feedback post interview, our policy prevents us from providing specific interview feedback to candidates.

What we expect from you

Respect your confidentiality agreements. We only know what you tell us, so don't tell us anything that is confidential or in violation of your agreements.

Choose examples from your experience. The most accurate predictor of future success is past performance, so structure your answers to highlight your unique skills and showcase your experience. Let us know what the situation was, what actions you took, and what impact your role had on the results.

Provide details. We are a technical organization, so understanding the specifics is important to us. Give a detailed account of the situation, and ensure each answer has a beginning, middle, and end. Avoid generalizations. Be prepared to answer follow-up questions with additional detail.

Prepare for your remote interview. Ensure your surroundings are tidy, well lit, and free from distractions. Check your hardware and software and confirm your device is charged prior to the interview. Given the global shift to a remote work environment, we understand you may have unique circumstances (pets, children, etc.) in your work area. Rest assured our interviewers are understanding of these situations. We're all in this together!

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Prepare for Your Interview

During your interviews for Oracle Cloud Infrastructure, you will be asked questions designed to prompt you to provide a real-life example of how you handled a certain kind of situation in the past. These behavioral-based interview questions help us understand how you cope with change, approach learning, and overcome challenges and obstacles.

When presented with a question that's behavioral in nature, consider providing your answers in the STAR format:

- S – Situation.** What was the situation that you were in, or the task you needed to accomplish?
- T – Task.** What goal were you working toward?
- A – Action.** Describe the actions you took to address the situation. What specific steps did you take?
- R – Result.** What happened because of your action? What did you learn?

Arrive prepared with examples of challenging situations that you have faced and provide details that highlight your experience. Describe and demonstrate ways you have succeeded, failed, taken risks, and grown in the process.

Consider how these examples align with the Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Core Values below and use them to guide the discussion.

Here are a few example questions to help you prepare for your interview:

- Tell me about a time you've had to prioritize your customers' needs. What was the situation? What did you do and how did it go? What would you do differently knowing what you know now?
- Describe a work situation where you faced a big obstacle. How did you overcome it?
- There is more than one way to solve a problem. Give an example from your recent work experience that would illustrate this.
- What do you do when priorities change quickly? Give one example of when this happened

STAR Method

We use the STAR method because it helps both candidates and interviewers by providing a framework for a simple checklist in their mind. The STAR method helps candidates walk through their stories in a logical, clear manner. Here are sample questions to ask for each section of STAR:

Situation

Interviewer asks about the challenge or situation in which the candidate found themselves, and can ask questions such as:

- What happened?
- How did this come about?
- Who was involved?
- What was the main issue?

Task

Interviewer looks for what the candidate was trying to achieve from the situation

- What responsibility did you take on to solve the problem?
- Did your manager assign this task to you?
- Did you take this task on your own?
- Did others have tasks as well?

Action

Interviewer looks for information on what the candidate did, why they did it and what the alternatives were

- What did you do first?
- How did the person/situation respond?
- What did you do next?

Result

Interviewer looks for the outcome of the candidate's actions

- What was the end result of the situation?
- Was your manager satisfied?
- Did you continue to handle this issue as time went on?
- Were you given new responsibilities because of this?

Ace your technical interview

Thank you for considering a career with Oracle Cloud Infrastructure! We have reimagined what the cloud can do for business, and are looking for a diverse team of creators who want to influence the future of our cloud technology.

You are the builder here and, as such, we want to help you show off the best of your abilities throughout the technical interview process. If applicable, we will be testing your coding skills and problem-solving abilities, as well as considering how well you'll fit into our company culture. We want to see how you think, how you solve a problem, and how you embody our values.

How to prepare

Whether you're a new coder or an experienced professional, it's always a good idea to do some prep work before a technical interview. We don't expect you to spend days preparing, so we rounded up our best advice from Oracle engineers and made a list of (optional) resources that will help you get up to speed if you need a refresher.

Step 1: Refresh on core computer science concepts

Interviewers will present problems and coding challenges from an array of topics, so it's best to re-familiarize yourself with coding principles such as:

- Data structures: Lists, stacks, queues, trees, hash tables, sets, tries, and graphs
- Algorithms: Sorting, recursion, searching, graph and tree algorithms, and dynamic programming
- Time and space efficiency (big-O analysis)

Read up

Your own bookshelf, local library, or favorite online reference sites can refresh your knowledge with a quick scan. Cracking the *Coding Interview* is certainly one of the most detailed guides available, but here are a few other recommendations from our engineers:

- *Introduction to Algorithms* by Charles E. Leiserson is the classic, but could be augmented by *The Algorithm Design Manual* by Steven S. Skiena, *Algorithms* (4th ed.) by Robert Sedgewick and Kevin Wayne, *Algorithms* by Sanjoy Dasgupta, Christos Papadimitriou and Umesh Vazirani, or Jeff Erickson's book-length algorithms [notes](#)
- *Programming Pearls* by Jon Bentley provides a great overview—and for those who really want to go deep, there's always *The Art of Computer Programming* by Donald Knuth
- *Open data structures* [textbook](#) is also a solid resource

Step 2: Practice problems

Throughout the process, you'll be presented with a problem to solve, asked to present a solution using code, and, time permitting, create a test case. You can solve coding problems in whichever language you feel most comfortable. You'll find practice exercises in many of the books above, as well as at these sites: <https://hackerrank.com>, <http://www.spoj.com>, <https://onlinejudge.org>. Here are some examples from our engineers:

1. Write a program that prints the numbers from 1 to 100. But for multiples of three print "Fizz" instead of the number and for multiples of five print "Buzz". For numbers which are multiples of both three and five print "FizzBuzz".
2. Given values of two values n_1 and n_2 in a Binary Search Tree, find the Lowest Common Ancestor (LCA). You may assume that both the values exist in the tree.

When you're practicing, try writing out solutions long-hand on paper. This will mimic the conditions of an interview in most cases, rather than using an IDE with code-completion. Things you struggle to remember are good things to review. Also, consider how you would communicate your work as you go. Remember, we want to understand how you solve problems and not just see the code.

Step 3: Ace the interview

The big day has come! Now here are some additional tips to ace the live interview process.

- Ask clarifying questions about requirements. If the question isn't 100% clear to you, please speak up! Sometimes there are ways to dramatically simplify a problem if you can impose a restriction on input, for example.
- Talk through your plan before jumping into code. Remember, we're interested in how you think about solving problems, not just how you write code. We're looking to see how you tackle real-world problems. Communicate, think out loud, and make it collaborative.
- If you get stuck, ask a question. It's OK to speak up during the coding process if you're not sure of the next step in the process.
- Going with the simple, brute-force, sub-optimal solution and then iterating on it for time and/or space efficiency is perfectly acceptable. In the worst case, having something working that you can give reasonable suggestions for improving beats having an incomplete implementation of the perfect solution.
- Once you've written out something, take a moment to come up with a simple test case and walk through it, if you have the time. Even if you don't have time to fully walk through a test run, take a minute to talk about how you would test your code.
- With virtual interviews becoming the norm, here are some bonus tips on how to nail the [video interview](#).

Finally, remember that these resources are optional and to be used as you wish. However, if this list feels intimidating in scope, or if there's something you're not reasonably fresh on, feel free to request more time to brush up before continuing your interview process.

Eager for more? Check out these other resources on how to avoid [common interview mistakes](#), and read these [top tips](#) from one of our Talent Advisors.

Tune in. Oracle Cloud Infrastructure is a newly created business within the Oracle family, so here are a few links to help you become familiar with our mission and goals:

Find more information about OCI [here](#).

We look forward to meeting you. Good luck!



Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Core Values

Put customers first

We exist to satisfy our customers. We do this by listening to them carefully, responding to them promptly, advising them honestly, and exceeding their expectations. We put doing the right thing for customers ahead of doing what they specifically say or ask for. When faced with a choice between what is easy for us and what is good for customers, customers win every time.

Act now, iterate

We favor action. Notice something that needs fixing? Fix it. See a gap? Fill it. Struggle with a bad process? Improve it. See room for improvement? Grow. We move quickly but deliberately, and we iterate toward better solutions. We recognize that a grungy solution now is superior to no solution at all. We keep it simple. We don't discuss endlessly, and we are scientific in our approach. We offer solutions, not problem statements.

Nail the basics

We focus on fundamentals over flash. We recognize when we don't have the basics in place, and we diligently work to fill the gaps. We recognize that the path to advanced solutions always runs through the basics. We focus our conversations and our products on what is currently appropriate. We make forward progress despite not having complete information or perfect solutions.

Expect and embrace change

We accept change as a given. We value people who align quickly with current priorities, who have situational awareness, and who are willing to adapt. We are not limited to priorities we set in the past. We do not hang on to outdated processes and goals, and we promote or accept new ideas fearlessly. We embrace change as an opportunity for growth and greater success.

Innovate together

We practice empathy and respect in our interactions. We challenge our internal biases and learn to be more effective allies. We seek and celebrate the diverse perspectives and thought leadership that add value to our workplace, teams, and products. We foster an inclusive environment where collaboration drives innovation. We provide the tools, processes, and resources to enable everyone to reach their full potential and find success together.

Take risks, remain calm

We take risks because they are necessary to our success; not taking risks is the biggest risk of all. We are logical and data-driven in assessing our risks. We react to unexpected situations by remaining calm, and then making and executing mitigation plans. We recognize that learning from our failures is part of our path to success.

Own without ego

We take responsibility for the state of our team, our products, and ourselves. We champion the ideas we believe in. We welcome all help and feedback, and we recognize and incorporate the best ideas offered. We are the first to admit when we are wrong. We believe that our team can produce far more together than we can as lone individuals. When we notice a problem, we either fix it ourselves or find another owner. We never say, "That's not my job."

Earn trust, give trust

We build trust by communicating openly and transparently. We give trust easily, and we recognize that trusting each other is essential to our success. We act responsibly, and we trust others to also be responsible. We don't let occasional failures and differences in work styles undermine our trust. We learn from failures rather than seeking to place blame, and we don't invoke rank to convince others we are right.

Take pride in your work

We strive for excellence in all that we do, and we take pride in our progress. We do our best when we are proud of what we do. We identify work that needs to be done to achieve our team goals, and we communicate those goals well to the broader organization. We take responsibility for either changing our work or changing ourselves when we don't find pride in our work. We invest broadly in things that allow us to excel at our jobs, dominate in the marketplace, and delight our customers. We achieve things of value, and we value our achievements.

Challenge ideas, champion execution

We ask why. We test the validity of ideas through rigor, research, and critical thinking. We have an obligation to create clarity for ourselves and others. We own decisions. We drive effective implementation.

